The House Desk

A guide for admins · 50pick

The desk lets the house take part in its own markets from ordinary player accounts, under limits you set. This guide explains what every control does, what to set it to, and what to check when an account is not betting.

The one rule that matters most

An account only bets when **every** condition is satisfied at once: the master switch is on, the account is Active, its limits are filled in, it has money, and its rules point at markets that actually exist. If any one of those is missing, it stays silent — and that is by design.

1 · Getting an account betting

Do these in order. Each step is a screen on the desk.

1. **Designate an account.** Pick an existing player account the desk will stake from, and confirm you have the holder's permission. The desk never creates accounts of its own. Search for it by handle, phone number or account ID — or, if you have none of those, pick it from the list of every account underneath the search: twenty to a page, sortable by account, joined and signed in, and it says why an account cannot be chosen.
2. **Fill in the money limits.** On the **Limits** tab. Every limit must have a number — an empty limit is treated as "refuse", not as "no limit", so a blank box stops the account betting.
3. **Choose the markets.** On the **Rules** tab, under Markets: tick **Up & Down** and/or **Polls**, then tick at least one **chain** or **category** underneath. Ticking a product without ticking anything under it reaches no market at all.
4. **Choose how it enters.** Tick at least one of Counter, Fill or Opener for each product you enabled. These are explained in section 2.
5. **Press Save.** Nothing on the Rules tab saves by itself.
6. **Press Start.** Read the sentence it answers with — if the account still cannot bet, it says why.
7. **Turn the master switch on.** Until it is on, nothing is staked by any account.

Ticking a product is not enough

Up & Down on with no chain ticked, or Polls on with no category ticked, reaches nothing. The desk will look completely healthy — Active, funded, limits set — and never place a bet. Always tick something underneath.

2 · The three ways an account enters a market

MODE	WHAT IT DOES	WHEN IT IS USEFUL
Counter	Answers a player's stake by taking the other side of the same market, a short while after they bet.	Keeps both sides of a market moving once players are already betting.
Fill	Evens up a thin side shortly before a market closes.	Stops a market finishing badly one-sided.
Opener	Places the first bet on a market nobody has bet on yet.	Gives players something to join. This is the only mode that acts on an empty market.

If nothing is happening, check Opener first
Counter and Fill both need players to have bet already — on a quiet market they correctly do nothing. Opener is the mode that starts things off, so an empty desk with only Counter and Fill enabled is working exactly as told.

How the desk shares markets between accounts

Only one account takes part in a market at a time. When several accounts could take the same market, the desk **draws one at random**. The draw is weighted: an account that has waited longer since its last bet is more likely to be drawn, so no account is ever left out, and nobody watching the markets can tell which account will bet next.

WHAT IS RANDOM	HOW
Which account bets	Drawn for every market, weighted by how long each account has waited. An account that has just been given a market is very unlikely to be drawn again straight away.
An Opener's side	A fair coin flip, made once for each market and never repeated, so it cannot be re-drawn until a preferred side comes up.
Timing and amounts	Every wait before a bet is drawn from the range you set, amounts vary by the jitter you set, and a Counter answers only as often as its react chance allows.

A Counter always takes the side opposite the player it answers, and a Fill always tops up the thinner side — that is what they are for. None of this tells anyone anything about the result: the desk never sees a result before a market settles.

"Passed on" — a market handed to the next account
If the account drawn for a market cannot bet when the moment comes — its own balance floor, its gap between bets, its schedule, or another of its own limits stops it — the market is not lost. The desk passes it to another account that has not tried it yet (up to four accounts in all). The activity tables show the first account's row as **Passed on**. It is normal and needs no action; if one account is passed over often, look at its limits and its balance.

Recommended starting settings for Up & Down

Up & Down rounds are short, and the price the desk decides on goes stale within a few minutes, so these values keep the desk inside the round:

SETTING	SET IT TO	WHY
Opener wait, maximum (Rules)	45 seconds	A longer wait lets the price go stale before the bet, and the bet is then refused. The desk now shortens the wait by itself when it must.
Gap between bets (Rules)	20–30 seconds	Short enough for an account to take part in several rounds a minute across chains, long enough to look natural.
Bets per market (Rules)	2 or more	Room for an Opener and a later answer to a player on the same round.
Bets per minute (Limits)	12	Most rounds open together on the minute. A lower limit makes the desk skip rounds at those moments.
Bets per day (Limits)	1,000	Counted over the last 24 hours, not since midnight. Below about 500 the desk runs out part-way through the day.
Balance (each holder)	Well above the balance floor	An account that would go below its floor is passed over until it is topped up.

3 · What each status means

STATUS	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
Active	Started and allowed to bet, subject to the master switch and its limits.	Nothing. If it is not betting, see section 5.
Paused	An officer stopped it. It keeps its settings.	Press Start when you want it back.
Auto-paused	The platform stopped it for a reason it will name — most often the holder changed their password, which withdraws their consent.	Read the reason on the account, put it right, then re-verify and Start.
Removed	Taken off the desk. Its record stays for the audit trail.	Designate it again if you need it back.

4 · Every setting, and what to set it to

These are on the **Rules** tab. Each one also shows this explanation, its allowed range and its recommended value on screen, under the box. **Use starting values** fills every empty box with the recommended figure at once; it does not save by itself.

Generated from the console's own field list — 30 settings across 8 groups.

Counter

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
Skip polls closing within	How close to a poll's closing time this account stops answering players there.	1 minute to 43,200 minutes	60 minutes
Pool total minimum	The least players must already have staked on a market before this account will answer them there.	TZS 0 to TZS 100,000,000	TZS 0
Pool total maximum	The most players may have staked on a market before this account stops answering them there. Empty means no ceiling.	TZS 0 to TZS 100,000,000	Leave empty (no limit)
Delay minimum	The shortest this account waits after a player's stake before answering it.	5 seconds to 600 seconds	15 seconds
Delay maximum	The longest it waits. Each answer draws its own wait between the two, so the replies are not identical.	5 seconds to 600 seconds	45 seconds
React probability	How often it answers a stake it could answer, out of a hundred. Below a hundred, some stakes are simply left alone.	0% to 100%	60%
Trigger stake minimum	The smallest player stake worth answering. Anything smaller is left alone.	platform minimum to platform maximum	the platform's own minimum stake
Trigger stake maximum	The largest player stake this account answers. Anything bigger is left alone.	platform minimum to platform maximum	TZS 200,000
Amount (% of the trigger stake)	The answer as a share of the stake it is answering, out of a hundred.	10% to 100%	80%
Amount (fixed)	The same amount every time, whatever the player staked.	platform minimum to platform maximum	—

Fill

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
Lead before cutoff (Up & Down)	How long before an Up & Down round closes this account may even up a thin side.	10 seconds to platform maximum	45 seconds
Lead before cutoff (polls)	How long before a poll closes this account may even up a thin side.	2 minutes to 1,440 minutes	30 minutes
Target thin share	The share of the money on a market the thin side is brought up to, out of a hundred.	10% to 50%	40%
Timing jitter	A random amount of time taken off the moment it would otherwise act, so it does not act at the same second every round.	0 seconds to 86,400 seconds	10 seconds

Opener

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
Delay minimum (Up & Down)	The shortest this account waits after an Up & Down round opens before placing the first bet.	1 second to platform maximum	20 seconds
Delay maximum (Up & Down)	The longest it waits. Each round draws its own wait between the two.	1 second to platform maximum	90 seconds
Delay minimum (polls)	The shortest this account waits after a poll is created before placing the first bet.	1 minute to 43,200 minutes	5 minutes
Delay maximum (polls)	The longest it waits. Each poll draws its own wait between the two.	1 minute to 43,200 minutes	30 minutes
Opener stake minimum	The smallest first bet on a market with nothing on it yet.	platform minimum to platform maximum	TZS 1,000
Opener stake maximum	The largest first bet on a market with nothing on it yet. The amount is drawn between the two.	platform minimum to platform maximum	TZS 5,000

Up & Down

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
Closeness	How far the price may have moved from where the round opened and this account will still take part. Smaller means it only bets while the price is close to the opening price.	0% to 100%	25%

Shaping

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
Round to	Every amount this account works out is rounded to a multiple of this, so its bets do not read as calculated.	100 to 5,000	500
Amount jitter	How far an amount may be moved up or down at random, out of a hundred.	0% to 30%	10%

Guards

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
No-react zone (Up & Down)	A stretch just before an Up & Down round closes in which a player's stake is never answered.	0 seconds to 300 seconds	30 seconds
No-react zone (polls)	A stretch just before a poll closes in which a player's stake is never answered.	0 minutes to 1,440 minutes	15 minutes
Min time to cutoff (Up & Down)	How much of an Up & Down round must still be left for this account to place anything at all.	10 seconds to 86,400 seconds	20 seconds
Min time to cutoff (polls)	How much of a poll must still be left for this account to place anything at all.	1 minute to 43,200 minutes	5 minutes

Enter now

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
Enter now thin stake	The amount used when an officer acts by hand on a poll whose two sides are uneven.	platform minimum to platform maximum	TZS 10,000
Enter now opener stake	The amount used when an officer acts by hand on a poll with no stakes on it yet.	platform minimum to platform maximum	TZS 2,000

Market cards

SETTING	WHAT IT MEANS	ALLOWED	WE RECOMMEND
Counts as	How many predictors this account adds to the count players see on a market it stakes on. 1 = counted like any player. Money and odds never change.	1 to 10,000	1

5 · An account is Active but not betting

Ask the desk first. On the account's own page, beside "Holder's transactions", there is a link that reads **"Why is it not staking?"**. Press it and the desk checks the markets that are open right now, exactly the way it does when it decides whether to bet, and tells you in plain words what it found — for example "51 markets looked at (25 to open and 26 to fill), and this account would stake on 1 of them right now", or the reasons it refused, commonest first. It changes nothing and stakes nothing; it only reports. If you have changed a setting, press it again and the answer changes with it.

It may also answer that the account **could stake, but another account is more likely to be drawn first**. That is not a fault: markets are drawn at random between the accounts that can take them, the longest-waiting most likely, so this account gets its share of the next markets that open. Nothing needs changing.

The list below is what to check if that answer does not make the cause obvious. The account's own row on the roster, and the panel beside the Rules form, will usually name the reason too.

CHECK	WHY IT STOPS THE ACCOUNT
Is the master switch on?	With it off, nothing is staked by any account, however healthy each one looks.
Is a chain or category ticked?	A ticked product with nothing ticked underneath reaches no market at all. This is the most common cause.
Is at least one entry mode on?	With none of Counter, Fill or Opener ticked, the account has no way to enter a market.
Is every money limit filled in?	A limit left empty is treated as "refuse". Blank boxes stop bets rather than allowing them.
Does the account hold enough money?	Its balance must stay above the balance floor after the stake, or the bet is refused.
Is a pool ceiling set to 0?	A pool maximum of 0 means "only bet when the pool holds nothing", which a Counter can never see. Leave it empty for no ceiling.
Is it inside its schedule?	Outside the days and hours you chose, it waits.
Has it already hit one of its limits?	Its row shows what it has used of each limit. A money limit (daily stake, daily loss) starts again at midnight, East Africa time; a bet count (per hour, per day) is counted over the last hour or the last 24 hours, so room comes back as its oldest bets drop out.
Are there markets open at all?	Up & Down chains must be running, and only Opener acts on a market with no bets yet.

6 · Did it win or lose?

Every bet an account places ends in one of four states. You can see them on the market itself and on the desk's **Activity** tab; what they came to in money over the last 7 days is on the desk's **Results** tab (below); and the ordinary money reports count house accounts as normal players, which is deliberate.

RESULT	WHAT HAPPENED	THE MONEY
Open	The market has not finished yet.	The stake is committed and counts towards open exposure.
Won	The market finished on the side the account took.	The stake comes back with its winnings, less the platform's usual charges.
Lost	The market finished on the other side.	The stake is gone. This is what the daily loss limit counts.
Void	Nobody took the other side, so there was no real contest.	The whole stake comes back as a refund. Neither a win nor a loss.

A row that never became a bet shows why instead: **Skipped** or **Expired** (the moment passed or the market changed), **Cancelled** (an officer or a stop cancelled it), or **Passed on** (the account's own limits stopped it, and the market went to another account — see section 2).

The desk's **Activity** tab shows the same word in its **Outcome** column. Each row there is one round: **Opening** is what the account held before that stake left, **Stake** is the bet, and **Closing** is what it held right after — so Opening less Stake is always Closing. A later payout or refund does not change that row.

Expect refunds on quiet markets — they are not a fault

An Opener places the first bet on an empty market. If no player joins before it closes, the market is one-sided and everyone is refunded. That is the system working correctly: the account risked nothing and lost nothing. A run of refunds means the markets were quiet, not that anything is broken.

Where to read the result

The desk's **Results** tab shows what the desk's finished stakes came to over the **last 7 days** (EAT), in words — *Profit TZS 12,600*, *Loss TZS 12,600* or *Even*, never a plus or minus sign. **By day** has one line per day for the whole desk, with how many stakes were placed; **By account** has each account's result today and over the 7 days. A stake counts on the day it was **placed** — the same day the daily loss limit counts it on — and a refund counts as nothing. A stake still running counts nothing until it finishes, so its day reads **Still running**, and can still change after midnight, until the last stake finishes and the day reads **Final**.

On the **Limits** tab, and on each account's own page, the daily loss limit has **two** rows against one cap. **Projected** is what could still be lost — your open stakes counted as though they all lost, which is what decides whether a new bet is allowed. **Settled** is what has actually finished: it reads *used TZS 4,000 of TZS 100,000* when the day is down, and ***ahead by TZS 186 · limit TZS 100,000*** when it is up. It is the same figure the Results tab shows for today — the whole desk's on the Limits tab, the account's own on its page.

The rest of the desk shows **risk** on purpose — staked today, what may still be lost, how close each limit is. For anything older than 7 days, use the ordinary money reports, where house accounts are counted exactly like any other player.

7 · Money limits

On the **Limits** tab, at two levels: limits on one account, and desk-wide limits that no account may exceed between them. The tighter of the two always wins.

An empty limit refuses; it does not permit

Leaving a money limit blank does not mean "no limit" — the desk treats an unset limit as a reason to refuse the bet. Fill every one in. This is deliberate: a limit nobody set should never be a limit nobody has.

8 · The master switch

One switch governs the whole desk. Turning it off stops every account immediately; bets already placed stand and settle normally. Turning it on or off is recorded with who did it and why.

Safe to use

Turning the switch off is the safest thing you can do if anything looks wrong. It stops new bets at once and changes nothing that has already happened.

9 · Reading the desk's tables

Every table on the desk works the same way.

1. **Sort by pressing a column's heading.** Press it to order the table by that column; press it again to reverse the order. The heading in force shows an arrow (↑ or ↓). Running figures — Opening, Closing and Left today — and a few descriptive columns do not sort, because their order only makes sense in time.

2. **Twenty rows to a page.** Every list that can grow — activity, history, targets, the list of accounts — shows twenty rows with a pager under it. The roster has one too, but it only appears if the maximum number of accounts is ever raised above twenty; until then every account is on one screen.

3. **A press that is loading says so.** When you press a tab, a heading, a page number or a filter, a thin moving bar appears under what you pressed and the part of the page it will replace fades, until the new page arrives. On a slow connection, wait for it — nothing is stuck.

On a phone

The two activity tables show each stake as a stacked card with no heading row, so on a phone they carry a **Sort · Panga** row above the first card instead: one button for each column you can sort by, the one in use marked with its arrow (↑ or ↓). Press a button to sort by that column; press the marked one again to reverse the order. It does exactly what pressing that column's heading does on a computer, and the line above it still says which order you are looking at. Every other table keeps its heading row on a phone and sorts from it.